

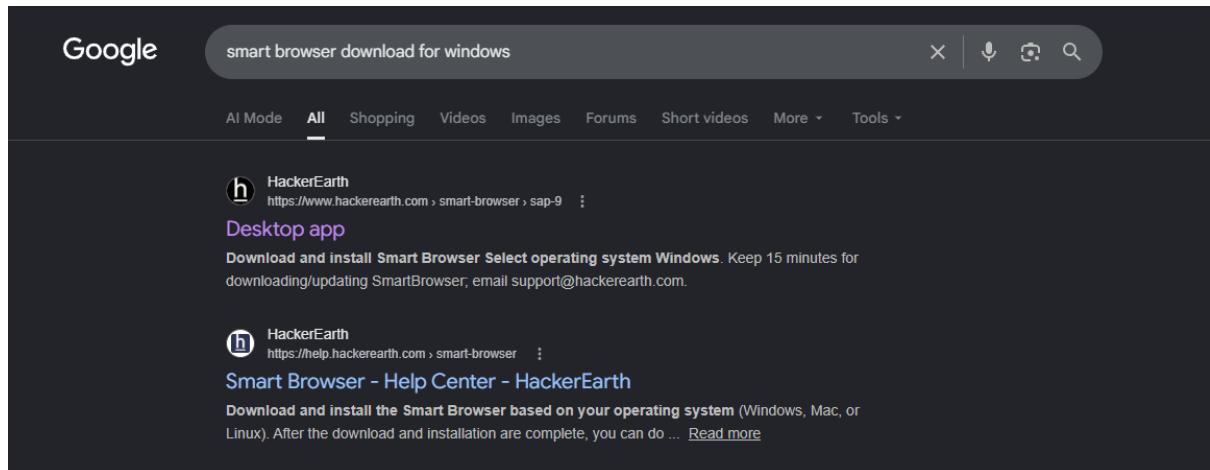
Setting Up Your Environment for Test.

Before Downloading the Smart Browser

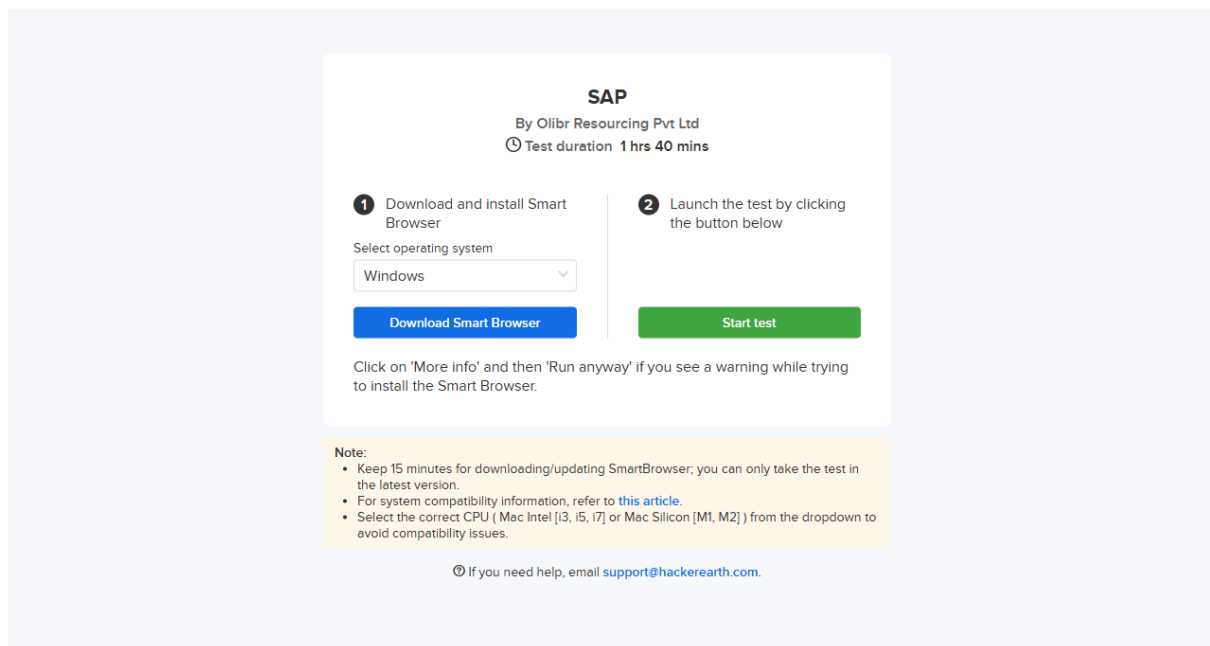
1. **Ensure you are using a WiFi connection** and not a mobile hotspot.
2. **Mandatory prerequisites:**
 - What is the operating system on the computer you are using (MacOS, Linux, or Windows)?
 - What is the version of your operating system?
 - **For Mac users only:**
 - What processor does your Mac computer have: the Intel processor or the Apple Silicon processor?
 - For information on how to figure out what processor your Mac has, [see this](#).
 - Update webcam drivers.
3. **Ensure that your system is compatible.** Here are the system compatibility details:
 - Windows 10 and 11
 - Linux Ubuntu 20.04 and Ubuntu 22.04
 - Mac 13.5 Ventura and above
4. **You cannot download Smart Browser if you are:**
 - Working with a firewall enabled
 - Using a VPN
5. **Close all applications**, including those running in the background (for example, WhatsApp, Chrome), and desktop widgets such as Clock and Calendar, to be able to proceed with the assessment.

Phase 1: Downloading And Installing Secure Broser

Step 1 : Click here to [Download](#) this software.



Step 2 : Select the installer file according to your environment.



Step 3: If you are using a virtual camera, you will see this error. Please ensure you are using either your laptop's built-in camera or a wired webcam to proceed.

System Check

Please wait while we verify your system meets all requirements

✓

✗

✗

STEP 2 OF 7

Failed

Software or virtual cameras are not allowed (e.g. OBS Virtual Camera, ManyCam). Disconnect or disable: DroidCam Source 2. Use only a physical webcam.

↻ Retry Check

SUPPORT

If you experience any issues during system checks, contact support@hackerearth.com and include your Device ID with a brief description of the problem.

DEVICE ID

22yuf1oxmwvmq20s1od

Copy ID

System Check

Please wait while we verify your system meets all requirements

✓

✓

✓

STEP 2 OF 7

Completed

Verify your camera feed below and continue when ready.

Live camera feed



Camera

Webcam C110 (046d:0829) ▾

→ Continue

 **SUPPORT**

If you experience any issues during system checks, contact support@hackerearth.com and include your Device ID with a brief description of the problem.

DEVICE ID

22yuf1oxmwvmq20slod

Copy ID

"Click 'Continue' to test all remaining requirements and finish the process."

Step 4: Open Application Check

Open Applications Check

Before proceeding with the test, we need to ensure no applications that could interfere with the test are running.

×

STEP 1 OF 1

Open applications found

Please close the following applications and windows before proceeding:

Microsoft Word

Brave Browser

Microsoft Edge

×

 Try Closing Automatically

↺

 Retry Check

If any applications or windows remain open after clicking "Try Closing", please close them manually through your operating system, then click "Retry Check" to continue.

🛠

SUPPORT

If you experience any issues during system checks, contact support@hackerearth.com and include your Device ID with a brief description of the problem.

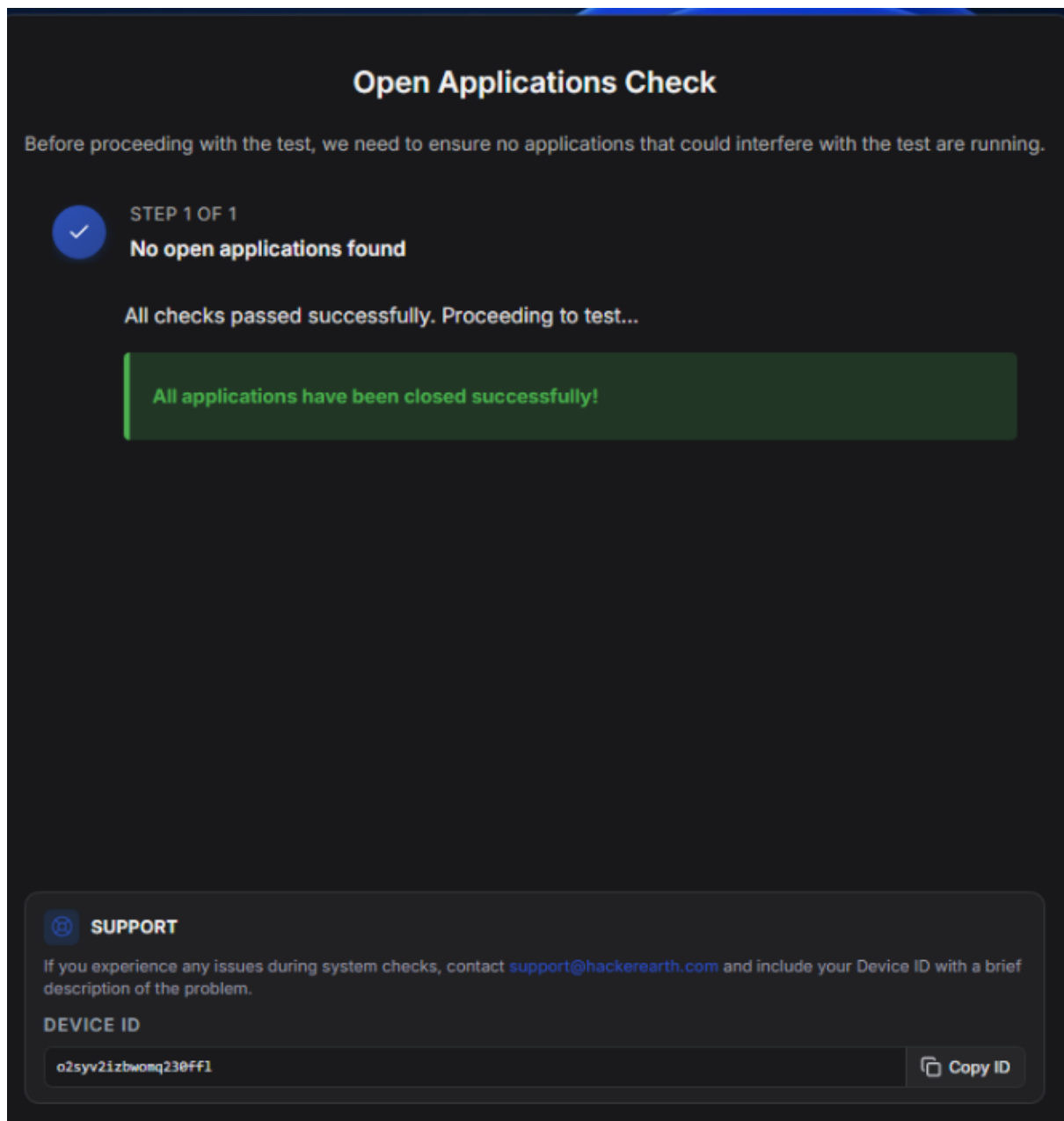
DEVICE ID

22yuf1oxmwvmq20slod

📋 Copy ID

Remember to close all other application instead of **Smart Browser**

After completing all the steps your screen looks like this.



Make sure your follow all the given instructions to process you test further.

After Downloading the Smart Browser

1. You cannot do the following while using Smart Browser:

- Share your screen
- Take screenshots of the test window
- Record the test window
- Keep any applications open (Chrome, WhatsApp - even if running in the background, etc.)
- Resize the test window
- Use multiple monitors

2. Key Combinations that are Absolutely Forbidden While Using Smart Browser

Operating System	Forbidden Key Combinations
All	Alt + Tab, Ctrl + Alt + Delete, OS superkeys and combos involving these keys, print screen and any combination involving this key, Ctrl + Shift + Esc, Alt + Esc, Ctrl + Alt + Shift, etc.
Mac	Command + H, Command + Option + H, Shift + Command (⌘) + 3, Shift + Command (⌘) + 4, Shift + Command (⌘) + 5, Control + Arrow (Up/Down), Command + Tab, Command + M, Command + Option + Esc, Command + Space, Command + Option + D, Control + Up Arrow, Control + Down Arrow, Command + ` (Backtick), Control + Command + F, Command + Shift + Option + Esc, Command + Shift + G, Command + Shift + N
Ubuntu	Ctrl + Alt + Shift + R, Ctrl + Alt + Arrow Key, Ctrl + Alt + Tab, Alt + Backtick (`), Ctrl + Alt + T, Ctrl + Alt + L, Ctrl + Shift + N

Phase 2: Advanced Proctoring Settings – Smart Browser

Smart Browser is a secure desktop application designed to conduct a fair, secure assessment.

HackerEarth's **Smart Browser** is a secure desktop application designed to help you conduct tests with enhanced proctoring. It offers stricter controls compared to standard browser-based tests, ensuring a more reliable and cheat-resistant testing experience.

By using Smart Browser, you can be more confident that candidates are completing assessments in a controlled and secure environment.

Smart Browser preview does not work for unpublished tests. You need to publish the test to preview it in the Smart Browser.

Supported Operating Systems

Smart Browser is supported by the following Operating Systems (OS):

OS	Versions
Windows	10, 11
Linux	Ubuntu 22.04, Ubuntu 20.04
4macOS	13.5 Ventura and above

Enable Smart Browser in settings

Admins can enable Smart Browser from the proctoring settings while creating or editing a test. Once enabled, candidates will be required to attempt the test using Smart Browser only.

How Smart Browser helps prevent cheating?

Smart Browser uses multiple security checks before and during the test to ensure fairness and integrity.

Security measures before the test

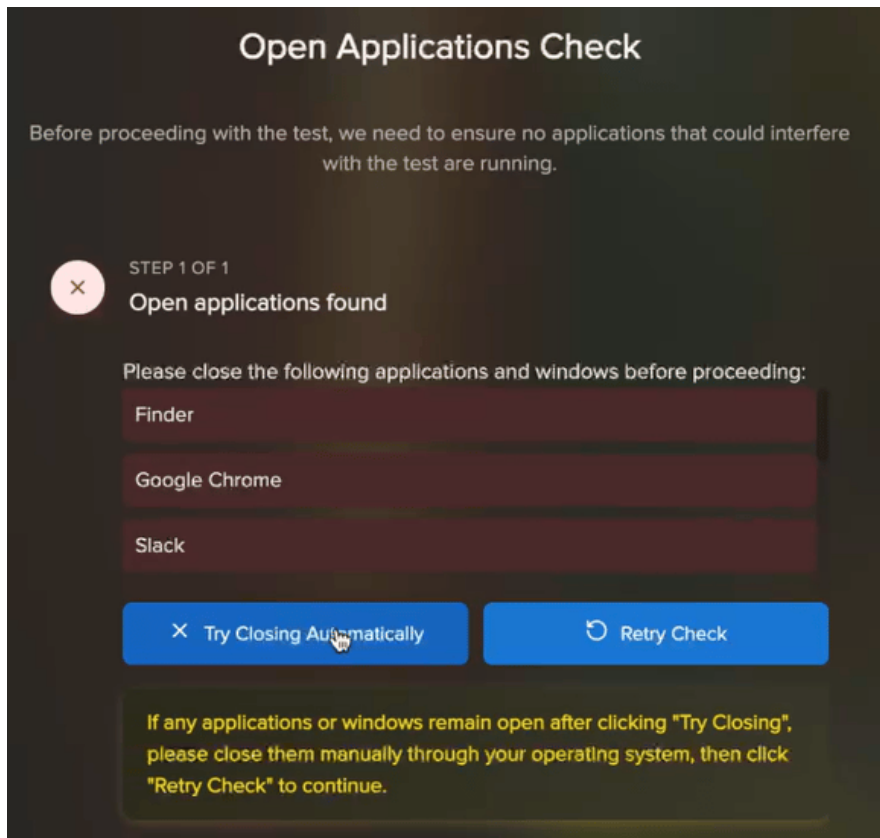
Before the test begins, Smart Browser verifies the candidate's system setup and ensures that all security requirements are met. Candidates must launch the test exclusively through the Smart Browser application.

Smart Browser performs a complete system check to:

- Detect whether the system is running in a virtual environment

- Ensure all display requirements are met
- Verify that the required domains are accessible
- Check for any open applications

If restricted applications are detected, you can choose to close them manually or allow Smart Browser to close them automatically.



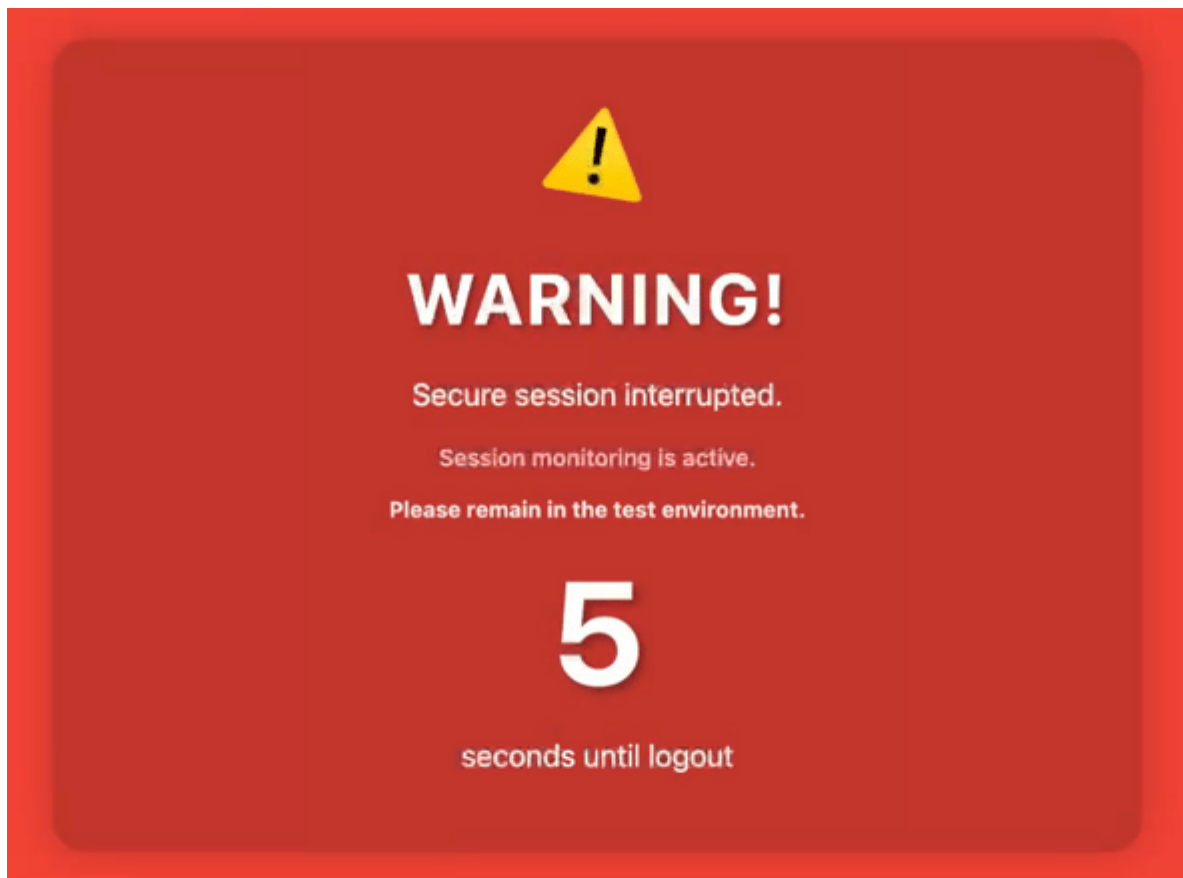
Security measures during the test

Once the test starts, Smart Browser actively restricts actions that could compromise test integrity. It prevents candidates from:

1. Sharing or recording the test window
2. Taking screenshots of the test
3. Opening or switching to other applications
4. Resizing the test window
5. Using multiple monitors
6. Running the test inside a virtual machine
7. Accessing browser developer tools

Any attempt by a candidate to move away from the test screen, such as switching workspaces, exiting full-screen mode, or opening another application in the background, will trigger a warning.

Candidates cannot open external links and applications while taking an assessment in the Smart Browser. Question types like **Machine Learning and File upload** that require candidates to use a separate application to solve **should not be used for assessments in the Smart Browser**.



If the candidate does not return to the test within 10 seconds after the initial warning, they will be automatically removed from the test.

Restricted keyboard actions

To maintain focus and prevent misuse, the following key combinations are disabled:

- Function keys and related combinations (for example, **F1**, **Alt + F5**)
- **Alt + Tab**
- **Ctrl + Alt + Delete**
- **Ctrl + C** and **Ctrl + V**
- Operating system shortcut keys (such as **Windows key**, **Mac Command key**, and combinations like **Windows key + C**)

Additional controls

- Operating system notifications are blocked
- Screen recording and screen-sharing tools are disabled

After the test

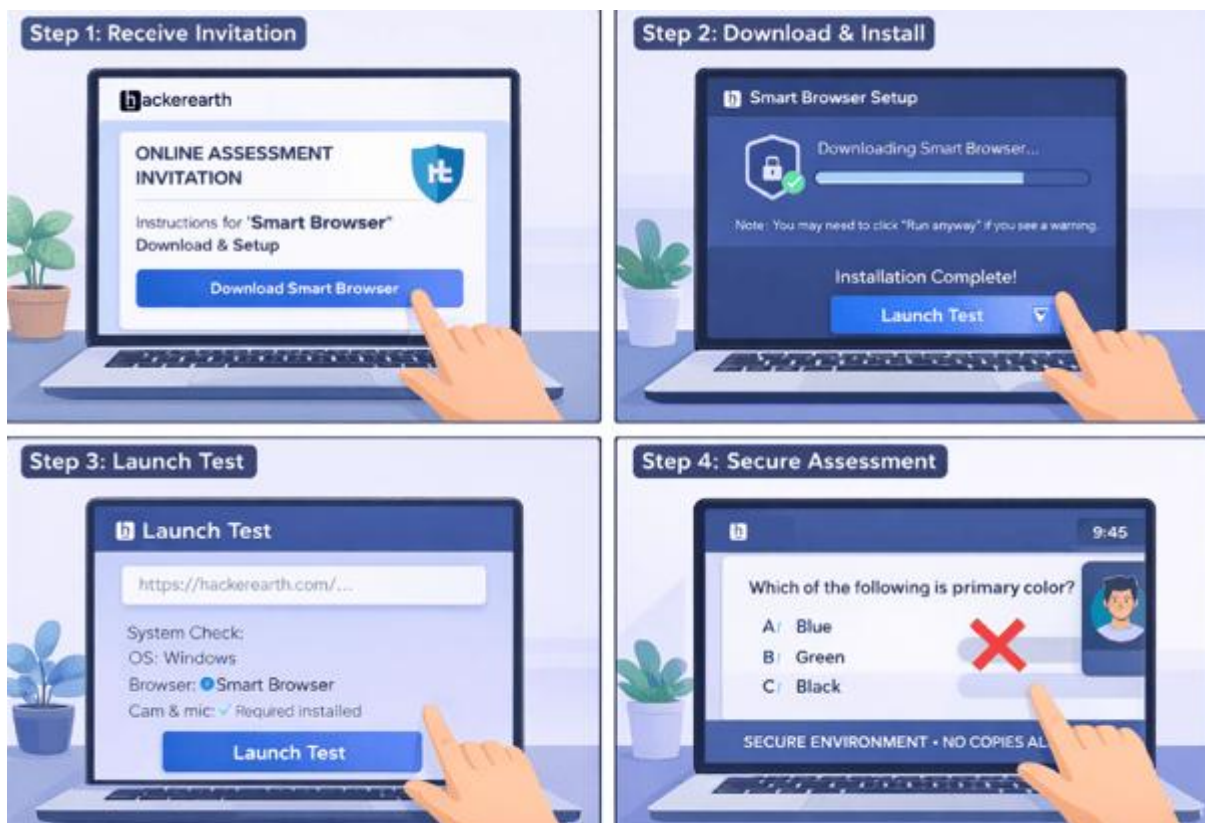
After the test is completed, Smart Browser safely exits the secure mode and restores normal system access.

You can additionally choose to receive the following test reports via email:

- **Email report:** Choose to email the assessment summary report to all Test Admins.
- **Plagiarism report:** Receive a detailed plagiarism report after the test is completed.
- **Detailed assessment report:** Include the detailed assessment report (PDF) along with the summary report.

Candidate journey using Smart Browser

The candidate experience with Smart Browser is simple and guided:



You can find more information about the candidate journey in [this article](#).

Phase 3: Smart Browser Overview & Documentation

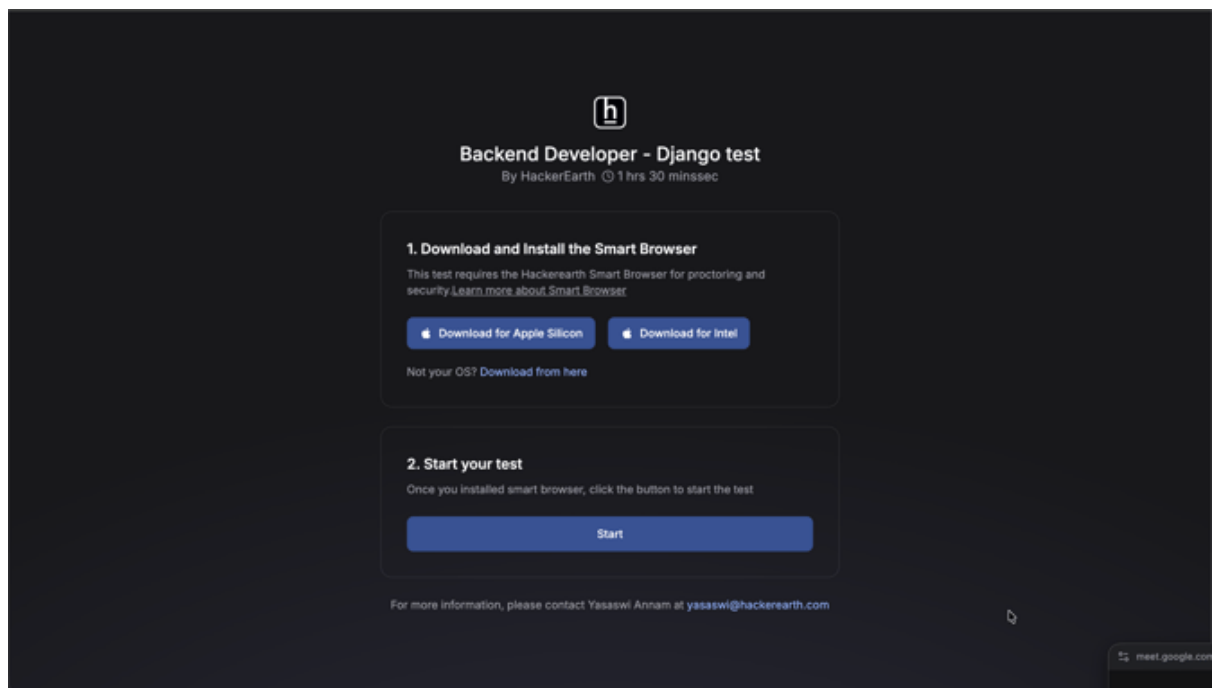
Supported operating systems for Smart Browser

Smart Browser is supported by the following Operating Systems (OS):

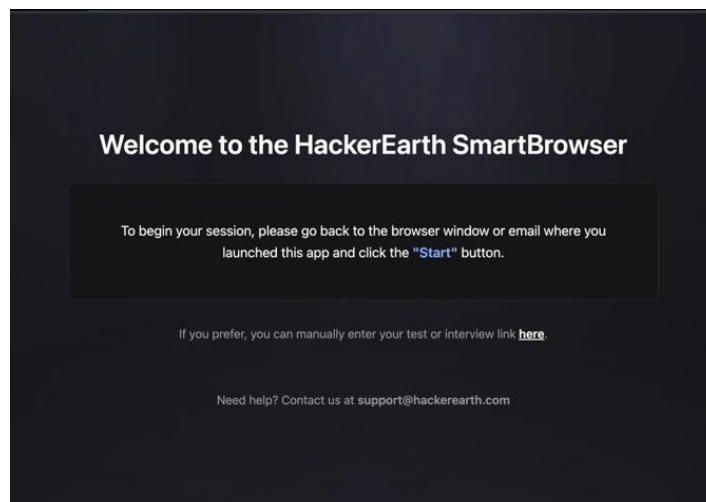
OS	Versions
Windows	10, 11
Linux	Ubuntu 22.04, Ubuntu 20.04, Ubuntu 24.04
MacOS	13.5 Ventura and above. Compatible with Intel-based Macs.

Test invite and setup

1. The test invite email includes a link to start your HackerEarth test.
2. Download and install the Smart Browser based on your operating system - choose **Download for Apple Silicon** or **Download for Intel** for Mac. If your OS is not shown on screen, click '**Download from here**', then select your OS from the dropdown and click '**Download**'.



- a. Open the Smart Browser - it will display a welcome screen prompting you to begin your session.
- b. Go back to the browser window or email where you launched the app and click the '**Start**' button.
- c. Alternatively, you can manually enter your test or interview link by clicking '**here**' in the Smart Browser. After the download and installation are complete, you can do the following.



If you have Smart Browser version **1.0.6 or older**, uninstall it and reinstall the latest version using the link in your invitation email.

Before the test

1. After installation, open the Smart Browser.
2. A quick system check is performed. And if everything goes well, you'll see a pop-up to enter the test URL.

Enter Test URL

Please enter the test URL from your invitation email to begin the test.
This URL will open in a secure test environment.

<https://hackerearth.com/...>

Launch Test

For the best experience, click the "Start Test" button directly from your invitation email. If you encounter any technical difficulties, please reach out to our support team at support@hackerearth.com for immediate assistance.

- Before starting the test, Smart Browser will prompt you to **close all background applications**. You can either close them manually or choose the option to close all apps automatically.

Open Applications Check

Before proceeding with the test, we need to ensure no applications that could interfere with the test are running.

STEP 1 OF 1
Open applications found

Please close the following applications and windows before proceeding:

- Finder
- Google Chrome
- Slack

Try Closing Automatically **Retry Check**

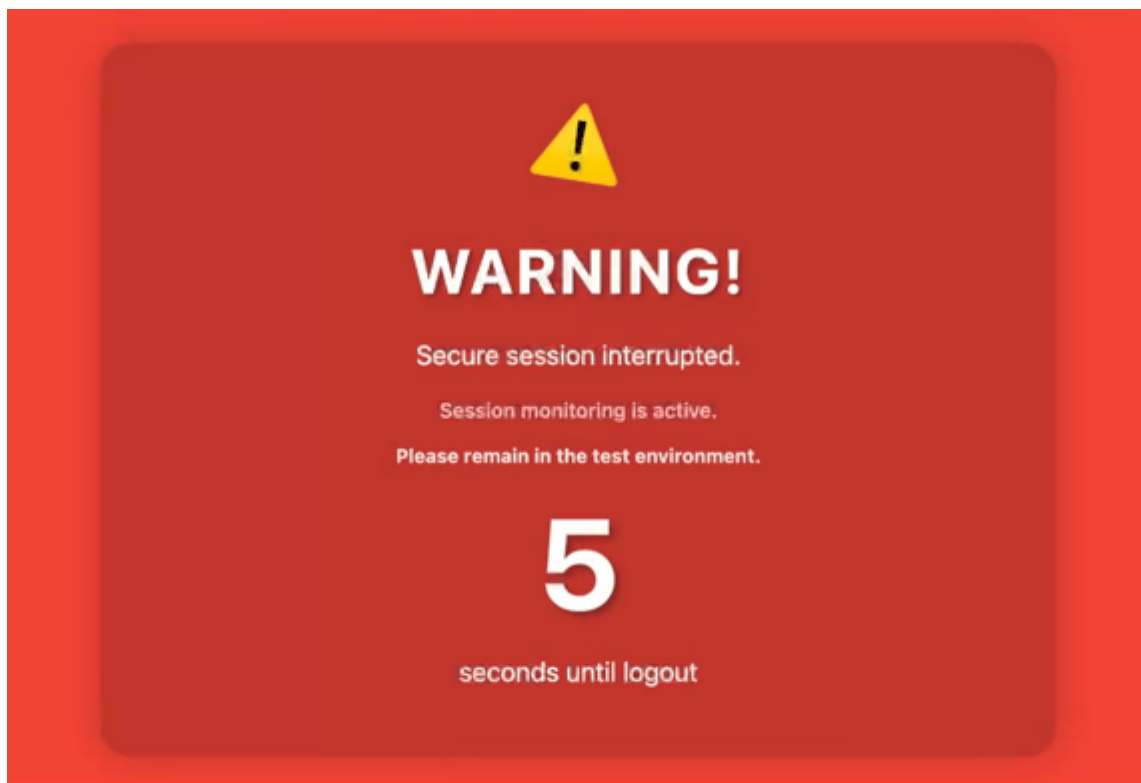
If any applications or windows remain open after clicking "Try Closing", please close them manually through your operating system, then click "Retry Check" to continue.

*Note: Some apps may not close even after selecting **Try Closing Automatically**. In those cases, you need to close them manually.*

During the test

1. Once the test begins, your screen is constantly monitored.
2. Any attempt to move away from the test screen (like **switching workspaces** or **exiting full screen**) or opening another application in the background will trigger a warning.

Note: *You will be removed from the test if you don't return to the test within 10 seconds after an initial warning.*



3. Do not try to record the screen or capture screenshots while attempting the test.
4. Once you complete the test, the Smart Browser will automatically close itself.

Important notes

1. If you're using a social login to access the test, make sure to select the correct account. You won't be able to go back to the previous

screen. To restart the process, you'll need to relaunch the Smart Browser.

2. If you're disconnected from the test due to a technical issue, you can resume the test by either:
 - a. Logging in again through the test invite email, or
 - b. Relaunching the Smart Browser application directly.
3. Avoid using any external tools such as Interview Coder or other platforms that provide outside assistance.
4. Do not use multiple monitors while attempting the test. Close any virtual machine running on your system, as it is not allowed while attempting the test.
5. We strongly recommend using a stable and reliable internet connection. Avoid mobile hotspots or tethered networks, as they may cause interruptions.
6. For questions (Full-stack) where a preview or external link needs to be opened, it will be opened in a floating window that can be closed and resized.

Phase 4: Troubleshooting Guide (including Snapshot Disabled Assessments)

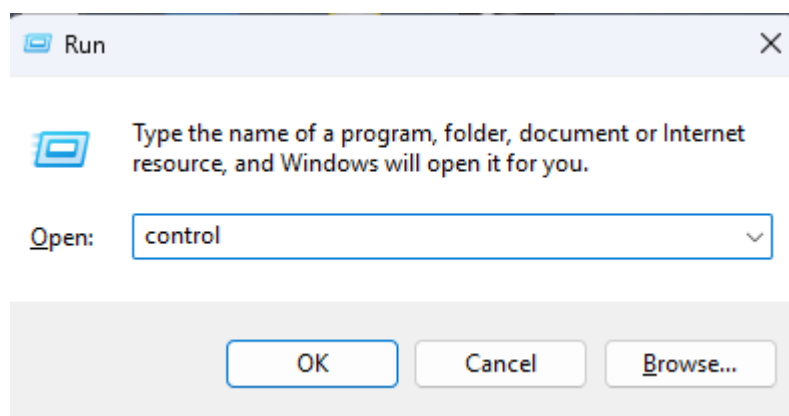
1. Firewall Issues

Candidates may encounter a firewall error due to the following reasons:

- The machine is connected to a VPN.
- Google APIs or HackerEarth domains are being blocked by the network.
- Candidates should try using a personal laptop instead of an official one.
- Alternatively, switching to a different network may resolve the issue.

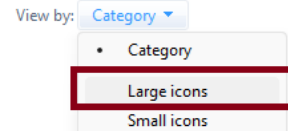
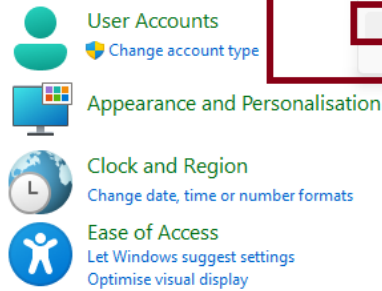
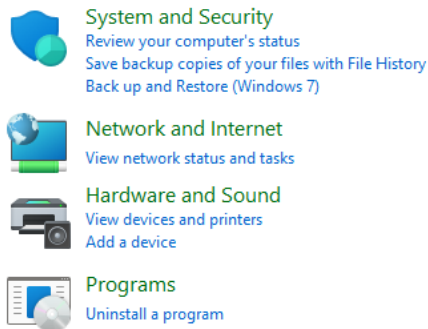
To turn off firewall follow these steps

Step 1: press **win+ r** to open run and type **control** to open control panel.



Step 2: Change **view by** category to **Large Icons** on top right of your control panel window.

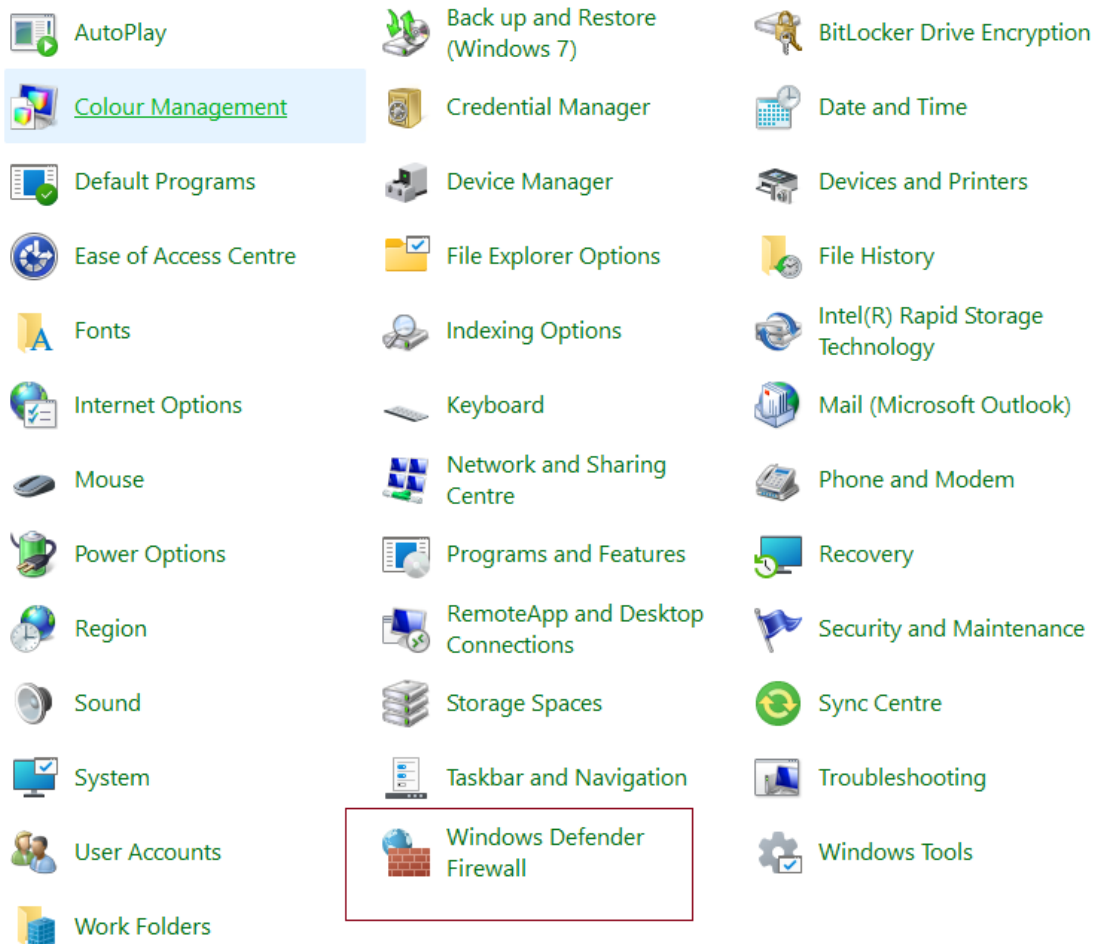
Adjust your computer's settings



Then click on **Windows Defender Firewall**

Adjust your computer's settings

View by: **Large icons**



Click on Windows Defender Firewall on or off

Control Panel Home

Allow an app or feature through Windows Defender Firewall

Change notification settings

Turn Windows Defender Firewall on or off

Restore defaults

Advanced settings

Troubleshoot my network

Help protect your PC with Windows Defender Firewall

Windows Defender Firewall can help to prevent hackers or malicious software from gaining access to your PC through the Internet or a network.

	Private networks	Not connected ▾
	Guest or public networks	Connected ^

Networks in public places such as airports or cafés

Windows Defender Firewall state:	On
Incoming connections:	Block all connections to applications that are not on the list of allowed applications
Active public networks:	Network 2
Notification state:	Notify me when Windows Defender Firewall blocks a new app

then click on both marked options to turn of the window firewall.

Customise settings for each type of network

You can modify the firewall settings for each type of network that you use.

Private network settings

- ☒ Turn on Windows Defender Firewall
- ☐ Block all incoming connections, including those in the list of allowed applications
- ☒ Notify me when Windows Defender Firewall blocks a new app

☐ Turn off Windows Defender Firewall (not recommended)

Public network settings

- ☒ Turn on Windows Defender Firewall
- ☐ Block all incoming connections, including those in the list of allowed applications
- ☒ Notify me when Windows Defender Firewall blocks a new app

☐ Turn off Windows Defender Firewall (not recommended)

2. 403 Access Denied Issue

Candidates may see a "403 Access Denied" error when attempting to access the page. This can occur due to incorrect login credentials.

- Verify that the login information is correct (email and password).
- If the issue persists, candidates should clear their browser history and cache or try accessing the page in incognito mode.

3. Test Loading Issues / Blank Screen / IDE Not Loading

Sometimes, candidates may face loading issues, such as a blank screen or an IDE not loading properly. These issues are often caused by unstable internet connectivity.

- Candidates should try pressing **Ctrl + Shift + R** (Hard Reload) to reload all resources from the webpage.
- We recommend switching to a more stable network to resolve the issue.

4. Tab Switches

Clicking on any notification or tab during the test can trigger a tab switch, which may affect the test flow.

- Candidates are requested to disable notifications before attempting the test to prevent any interruptions or tab switches.

5. Supported Browsers

HackerEarth Assessment supports the following browsers (up to the last 2 versions):

- **Mozilla Firefox**
- **Google Chrome**
- **Edge**
- **Safari**

Ensure that the candidate is using a supported browser and is on the latest version for optimal performance. Also, candidates will need to disable the browser extensions for smooth test experience.

6. Operating System (OS) Compatibility

HackerEarth Assessments supports the following Operating Systems:

- **Windows:** 10, 11
- **MacOS:** 13.5 Ventura

- **Linux:** Ubuntu 22.04, Ubuntu 20.04

7. Microphone Access Issues

Microphone access is required while attempting a test on **HackerEarth**.

- Ensure microphone access is enabled from the browser settings.
- Alternatively, enable it from the left icon on the address bar (in Edge and Chrome).

Candidates can refer to a video for a better understanding of how to enable microphone access.